

# Qroo Paul's Spanish Deep Dive

## Lesson 6 Summary

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Hey everybody, welcome to lesson 6 in the Spanish Deep Dive Series. In this one, I'm going to continue with my favorite subject, the subjunctive. I touched on the subjunctive in the last video and even covered a couple of "triggers"—those grammatical constructions that tell you the subjunctive is required.

This video will be all about subjunctive triggers. Now, here's my dilemma: this is a big topic, and there's a risk of information overload. If that happens, it's unlikely you'll get much out of this video. So, I've decided to dedicate this lesson to the triggers I use most often and show you how to use them. That way, you can cherry-pick what you like and add it to your own Spanish toolbox.

We're not going to cover anything from the last video. Instead, we'll start with:

**Describing Unspecified Items or People** The subjunctive is used when describing people or things that are not specific or certain.

#### Examples:

- *Quiero contratar al cantinero que sabe hacer 50 bebidas distintas.* (I want to hire the bartender who knows how to make 50 different drinks.)
- *Quiero contratar un cantinero que sepa preparar 50 bebidas distintas.* (I want to hire a bartender who knows how to make 50 different drinks.)
- *Quiero comprar la casa que tiene cuatro recámaras.* (I want to buy the house that has four bedrooms.)
- *Quiero comprar una casa que tenga cuatro recámaras.* (I want to buy a house that has four bedrooms.)

Another example:

- *Busco alguien que sepa pintar una casa.* (I'm looking for someone who knows how to paint a house.)

#### Verbs That Trigger the Subjunctive in This Context:

- **Buscar** (to look for)
- **Contratar** (to hire)

- **Necesitar** (to need)
- **Querer** (to want)

**Usage Tip:** With certain verbs like *buscar* (to look for), *contratar* (to hire), and *querer* (when used to look for someone), the personal "a" may or may not be used. When in doubt, use the personal "a" before objects that are people or pets.

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**Negation** The subjunctive is required in subordinate clauses after "que" when the main clause is negative.

**Pattern:** Negative Clause + "que" + Subjunctive

**Examples:**

- *Creo que Juan está en casa.* (I think Juan is at home.)
- *No creo que Juan esté en casa.* (I don't think Juan is at home.)

Additional examples:

- *Dudo que María quiera ir a la tienda.* (I doubt that Maria wants to go to the store.)
- *No parece que Linda quiera comprar el carro.* (It doesn't seem like Linda wants to buy the car.)

**Verbs That Trigger the Subjunctive in This Context:**

- **No creer** (to not believe)
  - **Dudar** (to doubt)
  - **No parecer** (to not seem)
  - **Negar** (to deny)
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**Verbs of Influence, Command, or Desire** Verbs that express wanting, permitting, forbidding, ordering, persuading, and recommending trigger the subjunctive.

**Key Examples:**

- *Quiero que vayas a la tienda.* (I want you to go to the store.)
- *Mi mujer deja que nuestros hijos vayan solos al parque.* (My wife lets our children go to the park alone.)

Additional examples:

- *Prefiero que te quedes en casa.* (I prefer you stay home.)
- *Mi madre insiste en que yo coma más verduras.* (My mother insists that I eat more vegetables.)
- *Quiero evitar que Juan se entere del incidente.* (I want to avoid that Juan finds out about the incident.)
- *Juan me dijo que fuera a la tienda.* (Juan told me to go to the store.)

### Verbs That Trigger the Subjunctive in This Context:

- **Querer** (to want)
  - **Dejar** (to let/allow)
  - **Preferir** (to prefer)
  - **Insistir en** (to insist on)
  - **Evitar** (to avoid)
  - **Mandar** (to order)
  - **Pedir** (to ask/request)
  - **Decir** (to tell, when giving a command)
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**Emotional Reactions or Value Judgments** The subjunctive is used after emotional reactions or value judgments.

**Pattern:** Emotional Reaction/Value Judgment + "que" + Subjunctive

### Key Examples:

- *Me gusta que Juan siempre llegue temprano.* (I like that Juan always arrives early.)
- *Me entristece que no quieras pasar tiempo conmigo.* (It saddens me that you don't want to spend time with me.)
- *Me alegra que hayas aprendido mucho viendo mis videos.* (I'm happy that you have learned a lot watching my videos.)
- *Me pone triste que Julio y Juan no se lleven bien.* (It makes me sad that Julio and Juan do not get along.)

- *Me sorprende mucho que Julio se negara a venir a la fiesta.* (It surprises me a lot that Julio refused to come to the party.)

### Verbs That Trigger the Subjunctive in This Context:

- **Gustar** (to like)
- **Entristecer** (to sadden)
- **Alegar** (to make happy)
- **Alegrarse de** (to become happy)
- **Poner(se)** (to make someone feel a certain way/to become)
- **Sorprender** (to surprise)
- **Molestar** (to bother)
- **Temer** (to fear)

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**Conclusion** In this lesson, we covered several common subjunctive triggers. These are essential tools to use in everyday Spanish. In the next video, I'll be focusing on the imperfect subjunctive—the one in the past tense. I have no doubt that there will be some subjunctive triggers mentioned as well. Until then, *hasta luego!*